Shelter Check

Find and verify your nearest shelters BEFORE you need them

Identify Shelters

- [ ] **Nearest public shelter — location identified**
  Check municipality website, building committee, or neighbours
- [ ] **Second nearest shelter — location identified**
  Backup in case primary is locked or full
- [ ] **Third nearest shelter — location identified**
  May be a public building with a Mamam
- [ ] **Building stairwell assessed as fallback**
  Windowless? Which floor is safest? Clear of obstacles?

Verify Access

- [ ] **Primary shelter — physically visited and confirmed accessible**
  Some shelters are locked; verify you can get in or know who has the key
- [ ] **Secondary shelter — physically visited and confirmed accessible**
- [ ] **Opening hours / access restrictions known**
  Some shelters are locked at night or require a code
- [ ] **Key holder or access code obtained (if applicable)**
  Building committee, municipality, or designated keyholder
- [ ] **Shelter is maintained and usable**
  Not used as storage, flooded, or blocked — report issues to municipality

Know the Route

- [ ] **Route to primary shelter — walked and timed**
  Can you make it within your area's time-to-shelter?
- [ ] **Route to secondary shelter — walked and timed**
- [ ] **Route walked at night**
  Is it lit? Can you navigate it in the dark with a torch?
- [ ] **Route is step-free or accessible (if needed)**
  Kerbs, stairs, uneven ground — can everyone in your household make it?
- [ ] **Obstacles identified and noted**
  Locked gates, construction, narrow passages

Time to Shelter

- [ ] **Time to shelter for your area — looked up and memorised**
  Check HFC Alerts tab at oref.org.il — enter your locality name
- [ ] **Realistic time test completed**
  Timed yourself and family at a fast walk, not a sprint
- [ ] **If shelter NOT reachable in time — fallback plan set**
  Inner stairwell or inner room identified and prepared

By: Daniel Rosehill + Claude Opus · Share freely with attribution
DISCLAIMER: This is NOT an official government resource. Use at your own risk. Guidance based on Home Front Command (Pikud HaOref) publications as of 12 March 2026. For official guidance visit oref.org.il.

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